Board Meeting Preparation and Decisions

Owner: Sam Rivera, Operations Manager

Approved: October 2, 2026

Meeting example: November 12, 2026

Purpose

Board materials should reach members with enough time to read, ask questions, and make informed decisions. This fictional board routine illustrates the benefit of documenting repeatable work rather than depending on one coordinator's memory.

Preparation calendar

Fourteen days before the meeting, Sam asks program and development leads for agenda requests. Ten days before, Finance prepares the preliminary budget summary. Seven days before, the Executive Director confirms the agenda and authorized supporting materials. Five days before, Sam shares the packet through the approved provider. Two days before, staff check room access and remote attendance arrangements.

Packet contents

The draft agenda, previous approved minutes, operational update, financial report, development summary and decision items. The packet should distinguish information items from requests for formal approval. Confidential personnel or supporter records require restricted access.

During the meeting

The secretary records attendance, motions, and decisions rather than trying to transcribe every word. Staff identify an owner and deadline for each approved action. A decision that has not been approved by the board should not be described as policy.

After the meeting

Within three working days, circulate draft minutes to the proper reviewers. Add action items to the approved tracker. Publish final minutes only after the organization's required approval process. Review unfinished actions before the next meeting.

Example actions

Sam will prepare a revised volunteer coverage summary by November 19. Priya will confirm who owns the donor thank-you process after Maya's transition. Jordan will share a proposal for first-shift feedback collection.

Review and records

Sam owns this process. Minutes, draft packets and action trackers should be stored in Governance / Board Meetings / 2026. OrgFlow can help a team find the procedure and related files; it does not replace formal governance approval.